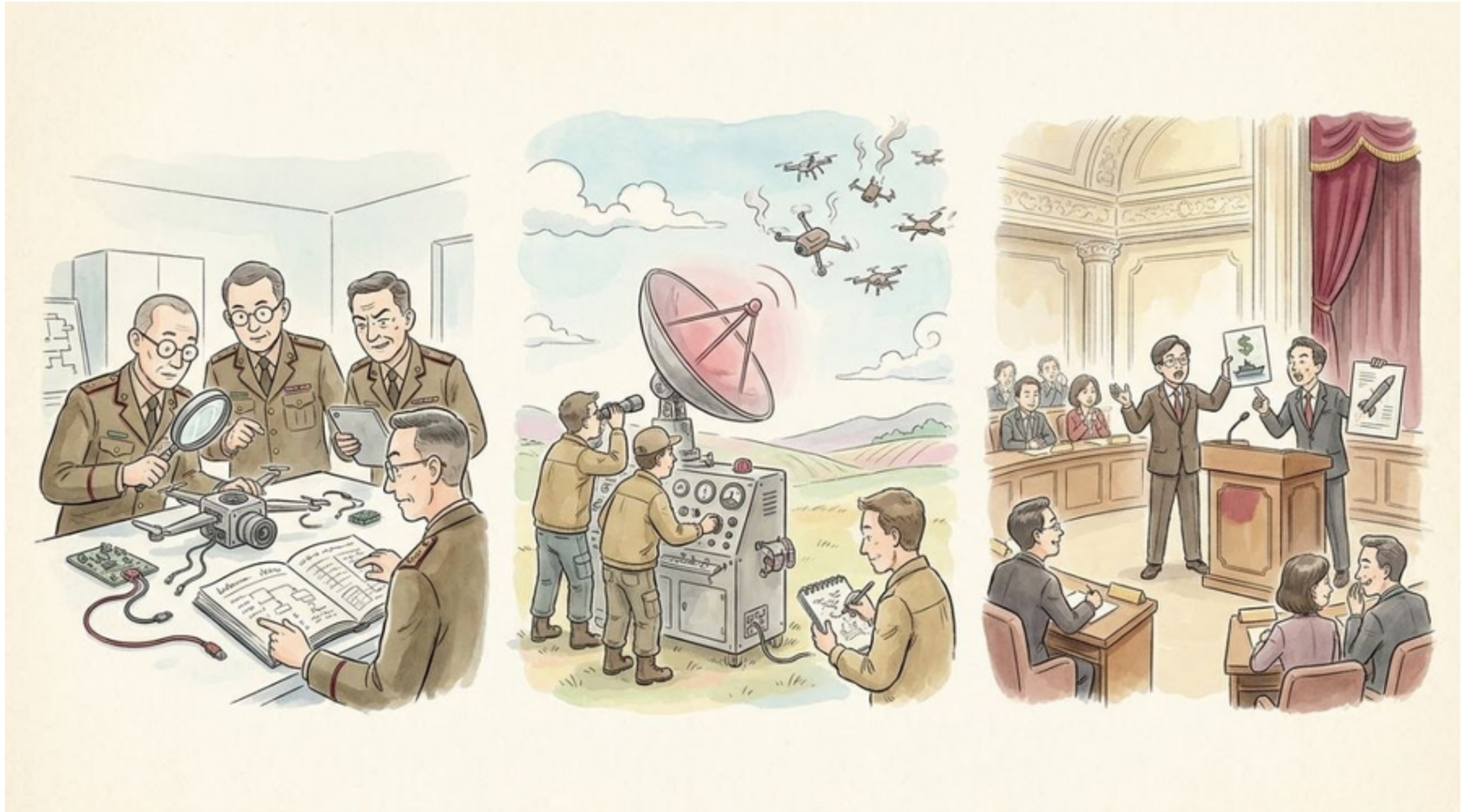


## Defense Brief

August 11, 2026



Royal Navy Drones Phoned Home to China, Marines Buy Microwave Swarm Killer, Taiwan Hits NT\$1T Defense Budget Without Drones

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## The Bottom Line

The defense supply chain emerged as the day's defining vulnerability. British naval drones carried Chinese-made cameras that secretly phoned home for five months, slipping right through NDAA certification. The US Marines bet \$11 million on microwave counter-drone tech designed to kill the fiber-optic drones that Russia fields daily in Ukraine. Taiwan broke NT\$1 trillion in defense spending but can't fund the drone production its strategy requires. And US Patriot interceptor stockpiles are down at least 65% from pre-war levels while Congress blocks the spending bill that would accelerate replacement. From procurement integrity to production timelines to legislative funding, the Western defense system's weakest link isn't technology — it's the institutional plumbing that moves technology from factory to force.

Read the full analysis at [frontion.news](https://frontion.news)